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# Senior Data Engineer

Government Digital Service

**Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 27th September 2026**



Government  
Digital Service

## Reference number

481087

## Salary

£56,850 - £67,150

£57,350 - £67,150 for National Based on capability. The base salary of this grade is £56,850 for other locations. Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay allowance.

**Job grade**

Grade 7

**Contract type**

Permanent

**Business area**

GDS - GOV.UK

**Type of role**

Digital

Engineering

Information Technology

**Working pattern**

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

**Number of jobs available**

1

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## Location

Bristol, Manchester

# About the job

## Job summary

The Government Digital Service (GDS) is the digital centre of government. We are responsible for setting, leading and delivering the vision for a modern digital government.

Our priorities are to drive a modern digital government, by:

1. joining up public sector services
2. harnessing the power of AI for the public good
3. strengthening and extending our digital and data public infrastructure
4. elevating leadership and investing in talent
5. funding for outcomes and procuring for growth and innovation
6. committing to transparency and driving accountability

We are home to the Incubator for Artificial Intelligence (I.AI), the world-leading GOV.UK and at the forefront of coordinating the UK's geospatial strategy and activity. We lead the Government Digital and Data function and champion the work of digital teams across government.

We're part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

The Government Digital Service is where talent translates into impact. From your first day, you'll be working with some of the world's most highly-skilled digital professionals, all contributing their knowledge to make change on a national scale.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation's highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need

Former DSIT recruitment campaigns are continuing as usual, but candidates should be aware that following the [Government's announcement](#) on the changes to some civil service departments, roles will be subject to the

machinery of government moves and will ultimately be in one of the new departments. We will provide more information if you are selected for a role. This work remains of high importance to the civil service, and we thank you for your continued interest.

## **Job description**

You will be a technical data expert in GOV.UK and the voice of authority with regards to data infrastructure. You will be a key point of contact for our use of Google Cloud and the adoption of new technologies to support and lead the use of data within GOV.UK and GDS driving innovation and best practice.

As a Senior Data Engineer you will be uniquely positioned, spanning the data professionals and the technical communities to build links and support cross pollination of work.

As a Senior Data Engineer you will:

- lead on the design and implementation of numerous complex data flows to connect operational systems, data for analytics and business intelligence (BI) systems

- enable and support teams to make better use of data to improve user experience of government services, through building and refining data models fit for consumption

- identify, define and evolve the technical standards, architectural principals and target state for GOV.UK's data infrastructure. Working closely with developers to bring data infrastructure in line with the standards of technical infrastructure

- identify areas of innovation in data tools and techniques and test and implement improvements

- be an active member of the tech and data engineering communities in GOV.UK and a technical expert for the GOV.UK Insights and Analytics team. You will be the link that joins our data and technical communities, mentoring, coaching or supporting the development of other data engineers

## Person specification

We're interested in people who:

can demonstrate experience of working with good data engineering principals, translating user requirements and raw data into effective, scalable, robust engineering solutions in line with build standards and data regulations, ensuring code is production ready

have experience providing technical leadership for data engineering teams, setting priorities and direction while establishing best practice and knowledge gaps

have significant practical experience developing production data solutions using Python and SQL, using Git-based workflows, code review and CI/CD practices to manage and deploy production code

can demonstrate strong practical background of using Google Cloud, including technologies such as BigQuery, Dataform and Composer

can work as part of a multidisciplinary team to plan and prioritise work, sometimes working independently and sometimes pairing with developers/data practitioners, and mentoring, coaching or supporting the development of other data engineers in the community

## Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours

a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%

25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days

an extra day off for the King's birthday

an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance

career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development

a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme

job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK

advances on pay, including for travel season tickets

death in service benefits

cycle to work scheme and facilities

access to an employee discounts scheme

10 learning days per year

volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)

access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at <https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk>

### **Office attendance**

The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.

DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

## **Things you need to know**

### **Artificial intelligence**

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and

internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

## **Selection process details**

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

- a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and cover letter of up to 750 words. Important tip - please ensure that your cover letter includes how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above

- a 20 minute screening call

- a 80 minute video interview, which includes a presentation on technical task.

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is:

- someone who can demonstrate strong practical background of using Google Cloud, including technologies such as BigQuery, Dataform and Composer.

In the Civil Service, we use [Success Profiles](#) to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following [Civil Service Behaviours](#):

- working together
- changing and improving
- Making effective decisions
- communicating and influencing
- delivering at pace

We ll also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the Government Digital and Data Capability Framework for the [Senior Data Engineer](#) role:

- Communicating between the technical and non-technical
- Data development process
- Data innovation
- Data integration design
- Problem management
- Technical understanding

## **Recruitment Timeline**

Sift completion: 2nd October

Phone interviews: 5th October onwards

Panel interviews: 19th October onwards

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) and [the Civil Service D&I Strategy](#).

## **Sponsorship**

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

## **Location**

Whilst this role's location is Bristol / Manchester, if you are a current Civil servant working in DSIT and based in London, you are also able to apply for this role. If you are successful, you will retain your London location and pay.

## **Successful candidates must pass a disclosure and barring security check.**

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For meaningful checks to be carried out, you will need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time, to enable appropriate checks to be carried out and produce a result which provides the required level of assurance. Whilst a lack of UK residency in itself is not necessarily a bar to a security clearance, and expectation of UK residency may range from 3 to 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements needed for the role may result in the withdrawal of provisional jobs offers.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

## **Security**

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\).](#)

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

## **Nationality requirements**

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

## **Working for the Civil Service**

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

## **Diversity and Inclusion**

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

## **Apply and further information**

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

## **Contact point for applicants**

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

## **Further information**

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact

[gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk](mailto:gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk) in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: [info@csc.gov.uk](mailto:info@csc.gov.uk) Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

